

Meeting Documentation

- "Think twice before you speak, because your words and influence will plant the seed of either success or failure in the mind of another." — *Napoleon Hill*
- "You don't think your way into a new kind of living. You live your way into a new kind of thinking." — *Henri J.M.*

6.1. MEANING OF NOTICE

A notice is a written or an oral statement that contains the particulars of holding a meeting. When a circular is served among the members of the meeting to attend the meeting, it is called a notice. It is a letter of invitation that carries the request to the members to attend a meeting. A notice includes time, place, date and agenda of a meeting. The notice should be sent by the proper authority in due time so that the members can attend the meeting on time.

So, notice is a formal written or formal information, notification or warning about a fact or an invitation to the concerned person for attending the meeting

6.1.1. Essential Elements or Factors of a Valid Notice

The essentials or elements or factors of a valid notice are given below:

1. **Signature.** The notice must be signed by the proper authority. Only the legal authority should serve the notice.
2. **Proper time.** The notice must be served in proper time. It should be circulated according to the rules and regulations of the company or the organization.
3. **Time date and place.** The time, date and place of the meeting must be stated in the notice.
4. **Unconditional.** There must be no condition or complexity in the notice about attending meetings. Always a notice is unconditional.
5. **Agenda.** Agenda means topics to be discussed in a meeting. A valid notice should contain the agenda of the meeting.
6. **Conciseness.** The notice must be short in size. It should be clear, simple and easy.

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7. **Proper persons.** Notice should be served to the proper persons who are entitled to attend the meeting.
8. **Enclosure.** An explanatory statement should be sent with the notice.

6.1.2. Notice of a Meeting

When a meeting is to be convened, a notice is required to be sent to all who are to attend it. It should satisfy these conditions:

1. It should be under proper authority
2. It should state the name of the organisation
3. It should start the day, date, time, and place. Also, sometimes, how to reach the place
4. It should be well in advance. Some require seven days' notice, some 48 hours'
5. It should state the purpose and, if possible, the agenda
6. It should carry the date of circulation and convener's/secretary's signature
7. It should go to all persons required at the meet
8. It should mention the TA/DA etc. payable and the arrangements for this

In practice, it is necessary to ensure that the notice has reached in time. This may be done telephonically. Dispatch section and post are prone to delays

We often find that between the date of a letter from a major public organisation and the postmark on the letter, there is a gap of 10-12 days. A notice that should reach seven days before a meet should not reach seven days after the meeting.

There are some examples.

1. Notice of the statutory meeting of a company

Eastern Jute Mills Ltd.
102, New York C/A
New York-1000

Date: March 20, 2015

NOTICE FOR STATUTORY MEETING

Notice is hereby given that the statutory meeting of the company will be held on March 30, 2015 at 12 p.m. at the registered office of the company according to the sectionof company Act, 1994.

Concerned shareholders are requested to attend the meeting.

Mr. John

Secretary

On behalf of the board
of directors.

2. Notice of the meeting of the board of directors

Supto and Co. Ltd.
12 KDA- New York
New York-9002

Date: March 10, 2016

NOTICE OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTOR'S MEETING

Dear Sir,

Being authorized I am informing you that the second meeting of the Board of Directors will be held at the head office of the company on March 20, 2016 at 10 a.m.

You are duly requested to attend the meeting.

Sincerely yours

John
Secretary

Agenda:

1.
2.
3.

Value points for each type of notice:

1. Notice-Meeting/ Event

- Target Group
- Name of the event
- Date
- Time
- Venue
- Agenda/Purpose
- Specific instructions (if any)
- Contact Person

2. Notice-Tour/Camp/Fair/Exhibition

- Target Group
- Event
- Occasion (if any)
- Date/Time/Duration
- Venue/Place of visit
- Objective-information/appeal/awareness/invitation
- Fee/Expenses

- Activities
- Specific instructions-do's and don'ts/things to carry/visiting hours etc.

3. Notice- Lost/Found

- Article Lost/Found
- Date/Time/Place
- Identification mark
- Contents
- Whom to contact/when/where
- Promise of a reward

Common Errors

- Students mention the name of the organisation first.
- Name of the event should come first as given in the format.
- Signature should be done in the end and then full name of the issuing authority to be mentioned.

Samples:

1. Traffic Advisory
2. School Notice-Meeting

DELHI POLICE FOR YOU. WITH YOU. ALWAYS.

NOTICE

1 JULY, 2016

TRAFFIC ADVISORY

In view of the persisting dense fog, the vehicle drivers and pedestrians are cautioned to show extreme restraint and alertness while using the road. Please drive slowly and keep the blinkers & fog lamps on. Pedestrians are requested to use the footpath and zebra crossing. Remember 'Safety Saves'.

Sd/-

Pankaj

Pankaj Mishra (Commissioner-Traffic)

1 JULY, 2016

MEETING OF SCIENCE SOCIETY

The office bearers of the Science Society are requested to attend a meeting with the Principal as per the details given below:

Date : 10th July, 2016

Time : 2 p.m. to 4 p.m.

Venue: Conference Hall

Agenda : To check out the details of the Science Fair to be organized on the occasion of National Science & Technology Day.

For further clarification please contact the undersigned.

SD/-

Vikram

VIKRAM SHARMA

(Secretary-Science Society)

SAMPLE QUESTION

Ashwani/Aastha Sharma, in charge of the NSS club of St. Andrew's School, Kashipur, is asked to write a notice about a fair being organised by the club to collect articles & money for people affected by floods in Uttaranchal. The notice will be put up for students on the school notice board. Write the notice in around 50 words, including relevant details such as purpose of fair; kind of stalls-games, food etc; contributions accepted; fair timing etc. in your notice so that students may contribute generously. Do not give extra information. Put the notice in a box.

St. Andrews School, Kashipur**NOTICE**

24 July, 2015

CHARITY FAIR

This is to inform all the students of the school that a Charity Fair is being organised by the NSS Club of the school to collect donations for the flood affected people of Uttaranchal. Students are also invited to put up various stalls for the fair with innovative games and activities or healthy food stalls. Any kind of contribution in cash or kind would be accepted during the fair.

The details of the fair are given below:

Date: 26th July, 2016

Time: 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.

Venue: School Playground

All are requested to participate wholeheartedly and contribute generously for this noble cause.

For further details, please contact the undersigned.

Sd/-

Astha

Astha Sharma

(NSS Club In-Charge)

6.2. MEMORANDUM AND CIRCULAR

Purpose of Memo. When you wish to write to someone within your own company, you will send a memorandum. Memos are used to communicate with other employees, may be located whether in the same office, in the same building, or in a branch office many miles away.

Because the interoffice memorandum form was developed to save time, the formality of an inside addresses, salutation, and complimentary closing is omitted. Otherwise, however, office memos and letters have a great deal in common.

Formality is Omitted. The memorandum or 'memo' is a very **flexible** form used within an **organization for communication at all levels** and for many different reasons. It performs internally the **same function as a letter does in external communication** by an organization, it is used for **reports, briefings or instructions, brief messages or 'notes' and any kind of internal communication** that is more easily or clearly conveyed in writing (rather than face-to-face or on the telephone).

Tone of Memorandums. In most companies and organization, **memorandums are written in the first person**, just as business letters are. Informal writing style characterizes the memos. The **tone of the memo is influenced by the position held by the writer** in relation to that held by the **receiver**. Also, the topic under consideration plays an important part in determining tone. Obviously a person writing to a company official to report the results of a financial audit will be more formal than a person writing a co-worker about some routine matter.

An important factor is the personality of the individual receiving the memorandum. The president, for example, may insist on informality, whereas a peer might like a formal, impersonal tone. Therefore, the effective business writer must evaluate the position of the reader, the topic under consideration, and the **personality of the reader** when setting the tone of the memo.

Flow of Memo. A memorandum may be send **upwards, downwards or sideways** in the organization. It may be **sent from one individual to another, from one department to another**

or from one individual to a department or larger body of staff. The channel will be the internal mail system of the organization, which may range from a bank of 'pigeon holes' for delivery and collection in person, to a desk-to-desk delivery system. Special 'internal mail envelopes', designed for re-use (allowing each recipient name to be simply crossed out and replaced with the next), are commonly used.

Format. Memorandum format will vary slightly according to the degree of formality required and the organization's policy on matters like filing and authorization of memoranda by their writer. Follow the conventions of 'house style' in your own organization. A typical format, including all the required elements, is illustrated below.

Writing Memorandums. There are usually three main parts to a memorandum:

1. The heading
2. The subject and date
3. The message

Occasionally, when official approval or authority is required, the memorandum may be concluded with a line for the signature of the person originating the correspondence: The Heading: the heading of a memorandum is usually printed.

6.3. AGENDA

As stated earlier, an agenda is the list of items to be considered at a meeting. It is also called business or order of business. It comes from the Latin word *agendum* (singular) which means 'a thing to be done.' But *agenda* (the Latin plural) is used as a singular noun.

It is the route map of the meeting. The specimen notices above already contain a hint of how it is written. The agenda may be a part of the notice or may be attached as an annexure. The convener/secretary prepares it in consultation with the chairperson and gets his approval.

The items of agenda should cover all that is necessary to be considered at that time. Meetings take time and effort to arrange; hence the agenda has to be well thought out.

6.3.1. Importance of Agenda

When employees are expected to attend a meeting, they expect there to be organization and flow. They want to be on the same page so discussion can lead to action. Without an agenda, key information about the meeting topics and goals eludes them. They might have a vague sense of what the meeting is about. However, they don't have the full story of what will happen at the meeting.

Lack of an agenda can make a meeting less productive, as participants do not receive information prior to the meeting that would have helped them prepare. Participants may not fully engage in the discussion because they feel lost or are not informed about the topic. Clearing up questions during the meeting tacks on time and makes meetings go longer, another common pitfall. People have limited time in an increasingly busy work world. Meeting attendees have a right to know what they are spending their time on, and what they need to contribute to the meeting. Without this information, the meeting might, for them, seem like a waste of time. And it can be a waste

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of time for you and your company if the meeting fails to meet the goals set because people were not informed.

The items may be devised from:

1. Previous minutes.
2. Suggestions received.
3. Actions and events since last meeting.
4. Correspondence of the organisation.

The agenda contains routine items as well as special ones.

Here are some guidelines for listing the items :

1. Apologies from absent members (need not be written previously).
2. Condolences if any (may or may not be written previously).
3. Reading and approval of the minutes of the last meet.
4. Matters arising out of previous meet's minutes (this need not always be mentioned).
5. Urgent and non-controversial items.
6. Matters requiring closer discussion and debates.
7. Any new, on-the-spot items with the approval of the chairman.
8. The Date of the next meets.

The last item in a meeting is a vote of thanks to the chairman, but this need to be mentioned. The items are mentioned briefly or elaborated according to the practice or need.

The style used is as follows:

1. Appointment of auditors.
2. Induction of new members.
3. Reading of minutes.
4. Felicitating so-and-so on the award of Padmashri to him/her.

OR

1. To read and approve the minutes of the previous meet
2. To consider the advertisement draft
3. To organize a blood donation camp
4. To appoint sub-committees for sports competition and music competition

The agenda should be manageable within the time at disposal. Some clubs have a time limit for the duration of a meeting (e.g., 90 minutes), which automatically dictates the scope of discussion.

6.3.2. 5 Fast Tips for Preparing a Board Meeting Agenda

1. Determine the goals of the meeting. Work in conjunction with attendees to determine the purpose of the meeting; for example, status reporting, problem solving, etc.

2. **Identify agenda items for the meeting.** Determine agenda items and related goals, the respective attendees responsible for leading each particular agenda item and the timings for discussions.
3. **Organise the agenda.** Identify high priority items, or those that require lengthy discussion and position them at the top of the agenda and inferior items at the bottom.
4. **Give advance direction.** Inform attendees if they are required to speak in relation to an agenda item or to bring anything with them to the meeting in advance of dispatching the agenda.
5. **Conform to the agenda.** Begin and end the meeting on time and observe time allocations. Consider including a 'round robin' discussion after all agenda items have been addressed, with 5 minutes allocated per person to moot other relevant issues and note issues which arise, to be discussed at subsequent meetings.

Specimen agendas

1.

Suyash Cooperative Society Pune

AGENDA of the 44th Meeting dated 1.9.2011

1. To confirm the minutes of the 43rd meeting (1.8.2011) copy enclosed.
2. To sanction loans to eligible applicants {copies of applications to follow}.
3. To review the working of the Canteen Committee.
4. Any other matter with the approval of the Chair.
5. Next meeting.

2.

332nd Meeting of AJ Inkya Coop. Society

Lucknow

AGENDA

- (a) To read and approve the minutes of the 331st meet dated 15th August.
- (b) To extend the lease to Mayor Orchards.
- (c) To reconsider the decision to purchase a second-hand car (taken in the meeting dated 15th July).
- (d) To conduct a health camp.
- (e) Any other matter with the Chair's approval.

6.4. MINUTES OF THE MEETING

The minutes of a meeting are the record of the discussions/decisions therein. They have an official status; they are useful in law, and in some cases required by law to be written. Minutes are final when they are approved by the members of the group to which they relate, generally in the next meeting, and signed by the chairperson.

Even if there are emotional moments in a meet, the minutes are written in an unemotional manner, are cool, factual, impersonal, and impartial. Moreover, such are the demands of time on most people that the minutes should be concise, boiled down to the essentials.

Only some organization's require that they record the detailed discussions as well (*i.e.* who said what and what were the reactions to the decision was reached). Normally, the body of the minute's records.

1. The motions and amendments there to
2. The proposer and seconded of motions
3. The details of voting, if any
4. Recommendations.
5. Decisions/ resolutions.
6. Tasks assigned to individuals, sub-committees

The overall minutes should give:

1. The name of the organisation/ unit.
2. Day, date, time and place.
3. Number in order (*e.g.*, 33 meeting of ...).
4. Names of chairperson and secretary.
5. Names of members present.
6. Names of the absent.
7. Attendees by special invitation, *e.g.* auditory, caterer, etc.
8. A Record of the transactions (on the guidelines given above)
9. Signature of secretary and, after approval, that of the chairman.

Tips for writing minutes. The minutes are written generally by the secretary from the notes taken during the meet. He/she can use the agenda as the framework for writing them and use short forms, shorthand etc. to take quick and accurate notes. He may have to ask members to repeat their words to get them right.

He should note down all the particulars needed for the fair copy of the minutes. The items of the minutes can be written under short headings such as are used in the agenda.

(As for reading them, some committees circulate them in advance and take them as read. Otherwise the reader should read them loudly, clearly, and quickly.)

Style wise, they use one of these constructions:

1. It was resolved that the minutes of the previous meeting be approved.
2. It was decided that a sub-committee be set up to consider
3. Resolved that a blood donation camp be held on 15th August. (The verb is used in the subjunctive mood: "be done, be appointed", etc.)

Alternatively, the description is given in the past tense:

1. **Minutes of the last meet.** The secretary read out the minutes of the meet dated... and they were approved.
2. **Donation received.** The chairman informed that he had received a donation of Rs. 50,000 from ex-member Mr. Gopal Rathi.

At the time of approval, the chairman asks, "Do you accept the minutes as they stand?" OR "Any matters arising out of the minutes?"

Your ability to write good minutes can earn you a prize position in an organisation. Also, if you hold a position and do not know how to write minutes, you may face embarrassment.

1. Specimen minutes

Archana Literary Society, New Delhi **Minutes of Meeting dated 1st August 1999**

Place and Time of Meeting	Residence of President Dr. Mansha Khan at A-12 Connaught Circus, 3.10 p.m.
Rod Call	Members present: Dr. Mansha Khan (Chairman) Mrs. Padma Raut Col. Devrajan (Secretary) Ms. Dilnawaz Kantawala Mr. Bharatendu Jain Mr. Prabhat Kumar Khatri Mr. Amrit Bose Mrs. Amrira Bose
Members absent:	Dr. Rajan Chhabra
Approval of Minutes of the Last Meeting	The minutes of the meeting dated 25 th June was read by the secretary and confirmed
Treasurer's Report	The treasurer Mr. B Jain, circulated his report of the earnings and outgoings of the fete held on 10 th July, which was accepted.
Briefing for All-India Poetry Meet	The President Dr. Mansha Khan briefed the members about their roles in the forthcoming All India Poetry Meet at the Red Fort on 26 th January 2000.

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Induction of New Members

The membership applications of four applicants -
Dr. D. K. Dawani
Ms. Snehlata Sharma
Mr. L. K. Gosai and
Mrs. Geeta Harivanshi were accepted. The application of
Prof. F.F.Guha was held in abeyance owing to invalid
recommendation

Sub-committee for
Publication Unit

A sub-committee of three members -
Mr. Devrajan
Mr. Amrit Bose
Mrs. Amrita Bose
was set up for munching a publication unit

Date of Next Meeting

The next meeting was scheduled for 15th September

Col. Devrajan
Secretary

2. Specimen minutes

SBI Zonal Office Employee's Welfare Organisation Aurangabad Minutes of Executive Committee Meeting

Meeting No.: 15

Date : Sunday, 1 January 2011

Present : ABC (Chairman)
DEF (Secretary)
GHI
KLM

Time : 9.15 a.m.

Place : Staff Warfare Hall
NOP
QRS
TUV

Absent: None

S.No. Item

1. Meeting called to order at 9 20 am
2. Minutes of the 14th meeting dated 20th November 2006 read and accepted.
3. DEF proposed and TUV recommended and ABC was renominated chairman for the year 2011 unanimously.
4. Sankrantri get-together decided to be held on 15th January Sub-committee to be headed by NOP, with GHI and QRS as members.
5. Meditation camp decided to be organised in the first week of February under the guidance of Swami Swarajanand. DEF to head the organising.
6. Next meeting to be held on 31th January.
7. The Meeting ended at 10.05 a.m. with a vote of thanks to the Chair.

DEF
Secretary

6.4.1. Do's and Don'ts

Do write minutes soon after the meeting--preferably within 48 hours. That way, those who attended can be reminded of action items, and those who did not attend will promptly know what happened.

Don't skip writing minutes just because everyone attended the meeting and knows what happened. Meeting notes serve as a record of the meeting long after people forget what happened.

Don't describe all the "he said, she said" details unless those details are very important. Record topics discussed, decisions made, and action items.

Don't include any information that will embarrass anyone (for example, "Then Terry left the room in tears").

Do use positive language. Rather than describing the discussion as heated or angry, use passionate, lively, or energetic all of which are just as true as the negative words.

Do have a new year filled with productive meetings captured efficiently in crisp, clear meeting notes!

6.4.2. What is the difference between Circular, Memo and Notice?

The main difference between these three forms of communication is their intended audience and their purpose. A circular tends to be mass distributed to a large number of people. A memo usually has a smaller demographic of audience and is usually more exclusive. A notice will normally be issued to a varying number of people; depending on who needs to know about the information it contains.

Circulars are most commonly used for advertising and making public statements. These can come in the form of posters, leaflets or handouts that make people aware of a particular subject. The audience for a circular can be as widespread as you wish depending on how many people you wish to make contact with.

Memos are less public and normally targeted at a more exclusive, smaller audience. They are often used as a way of reminding someone of something that needs to be done, or to pass on a proposal or idea of some kind. They are most commonly typed in today's technological era, however they can also be hand written.

Notices can vary in how many people they are aimed at. This is because they primarily function as a way of informing or making people aware of upcoming news, events or actions. For example, you may use a notice to make all of your employees aware of what the company will be doing in the upcoming year. However, you could also issue a notice to a particular department instead to inform them of news that is only relevant to them. These can also be in the form of posters or handouts, but could also appear in a mass email that is sent out to the particular audience

EXERCISE

1. The word "Memo" is a short form of 'Memorandum'. Explain.
2. Explain the characteristics of meeting.